A-A-54230
13 August 1990
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-36458B
16 July 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, RUBBER DAM CLAMP, DENTAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-F-36458B which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers a forceps for placing and removing rubber dam clamps on teeth.

Salient Characteristics:

Materials. The body and grip of the forceps shall be fabricated from class 4, type 420 stainless steel, except as an alternate the grip shall be fabricated from class 3, type 304 stainless steel. The rivet, yoke and spring shall be fabricated from austenitic stainless steel. Stainless steel shall conform to ASTM designation F 899 for composition. Composition shall be tested as specified herein.

Hardness. After proper stress relieving, type 420 steel shall have a Rockwell hardness of C48-C52. The spring shall be hardened to a spring temper. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM designation E 18 (Rockwell) or E 92 (Vickers).

Design and dimensions. The dental forceps shall be suitable for placing and removing rubber dam clamps on teeth. The forceps shall consist of a body with grip, a rivet, and a yoke and spring, and shall conform to Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 24016 for design and dimensions.

Corrosion resistance. The forceps shall meet the corrosion resistant requirements and tests as specified in ASTM designation F 1089.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

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Autoclavability. The forceps shall not fracture upon opening a number 8 rubber dam clamp ten times a distance of 1/2 ± 1/16 inch, after being ultrasonically cleaned and then subjected to 5 steam autoclave cycles using distilled water at 270 ± 5 °F, and 27 ± 1 psi for a minimum of 20 minutes.

Clamping force. The clamping force exerted by the operative points shall be 8 ± 4 ounces in the fully-closed position and 5 ± 1 pounds in the fully extended position when tested as specified herein.

Finish. Each component shall have a matte, bright or satin finish.

Identification marking. In addition to contractor markings, each forceps shall be marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer, if different from that of the contractor. The word "stainless" or "ss" shall also be marked on all instruments to identify the steel as stainless. As an alternate to the word "stainless" or "ss", the use of a registered trademark identifying the steel as stainless shall be acceptable, provided prior approval is received from the cognizant contracting officer. Forceps of foreign manufacture shall be marked with the country of origin. The manufacturer shall also provide a marking to trace the forceps to the contract and lot from which the instrument originated. All markings shall be legible and permanent.

Workmanship. Forceps shall be free from scratches, nicks, cuts and other defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability, proper functioning or intended use.

Unit. Each. (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit. Each forceps shall packaged in a close fitting container to prevent damage to the operative end.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after the delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an inspection level of II and an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps as specified in this description.

Examination. Examination shall be as specified herein. Examination shall include, but shall not be limited to the following:

Defects

Design not as specified.
Lock defective, binds or has excessive play.
Spring or rivet does not prevent yoke from slipping off the forceps.
Yoke does not hold forceps in desired position.
Spring fails to return jaws to closed position.
Serrations do not easily and positively engage yoke.

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Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified below. The acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.

Test Criteria

Characteristic	Inspection level
Chemical analysis	*
Hardness	S-2
Dimensions	S-2
Corrosion resistance	S-2
Autoclavability	S-2
Clamping force	S-2

* A sufficient quantity of each lot of metal used in the construction of the forceps may be selected for chemical analysis provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Chemical analysis. In the absence of certificates of quality, chemical analysis of the individual components of the forceps shall be determined in accordance with method 111 of FED-STD-151.

Dimensions. Dimensions shall be measured using an optical comparator, shadowgraph, or other suitable device capable of measuring the forceps dimensions with the accuracy specified in the drawing.

Clamping test. With the forceps rigidly supported in a suitable fixture, apply a force to the operative point opposing the forceps spring action and perpendicular to the forceps centerline. The force required to obtain impending motion in both the fully closed and fully open positions, when measured with a spring scale of suitable sensitivity, shall be as previously specified.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirement.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-531-6000	FORCEPS, RUBBER DAM CLAMP DENTAL

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PROJECT NO. 6520-2288
LOCATION: PB/WORD/CDDAMCF

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(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-54211	CARVER, DENTAL, (Binangle, Cleoid-Discoid, No. UWD-5)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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